

TERMINATOR: EXTINCTION

Written by

Bill Moldestad

Based on characters created by
James Cameron and Gale Anne Hurd

This is an original work of fan fiction. No copyright infringement is intended. Non-commercial. All rights belong to their respective owners.

Contact: billmoldestad@gmail.com

FADE IN:

BLACK SCREEN

LORA (V.O.)
Judgment Day.

BEGIN TO FADE
IN:

LORA (V.O.)
Three billion dead. Dark rain and
Machines took care of the rest.
There's maybe a few hundred of us
left.

EXT. MACHINE CITY - SUNSET

Chrome spires rising from the ruins of Los Angeles. Ash sky.
Hunter-Killers - HKs - launching from platforms in the
clouds.

Silence.

LORA (V.O.)
We built a virus that works. It's
finally ready.

The sun setting in the West.

INT. CENTRAL CORE - INTERFACE PORT

A crystal data disk.

Ribbons of light PULSE through the circuits. Rapid. Dying.

Subtitles: UPLOAD 98%... 99%...

CLOSE ON GENERAL SARA FREEMAN. Face lit by cold blue flicker.

DENNIS behind her. Facing the corridor they came through.
Rifle up. His back to her back.

FREEMAN
(whispering)
Come on, damn it.

DENNIS
(a dry rasp)
If we get out of here you owe me.

FREEMAN

The pool game? - cat's fault.

Dennis grins. Eyes never leaving the corridor.

EXT. MACHINE CITY PAD - CONTINUOUS

On the pad. Hundreds of feet above the clouds. Clean air. Clear. The setting sun bathing the HK in deep reds.

INTERCUT - INT. HK-AERIAL HUD:

Machine language characters fill the display.

Subtitles translate beneath:

SKYNET: IDENT REQUEST.

Beat.

HK-882: STANDBY MODE. AWAITING COMMAND.

BACK TO SCENE:

The HK on the pad below. Still. Engines idling. Playing dead.

INT. CENTRAL CORE - INTERFACE PORT - CONTINUOUS

The light current SLOWS.

Freeman reaches back. Her hand finds Dennis's arm. Squeezes. Eyes still on the upload.

UPLOAD 100%.

He turns. The kiss. Quick. The upload dying between them.

Freeman pulls the disk free.

FREEMAN

Let's go.

THUD. Heavy movement.

BOOM. A bulkhead SHUDDERS.

FREEMAN (CONT'D)

MOVE.

Dennis grabs Freeman's shoulder. Pushes her ahead of him. Puts himself between her and the chrome.

White. Everywhere. Blinding.

T-800 endoskeletons erupt from the haze. Chrome skulls. No flesh. Ghosts in the glare.

PLASMA BOLTS strobe the corridors.

Bullets punch black holes in white walls.

Plasma scorches the rest. Orange craters cooling to black.

High-speed retreat. Running blind through the glare.

Dennis at the back. Covering fire. Two soldiers with him. One falls. Then the other.

THE PLATFORM:

The HK – engines spooling, lifting off the deck. It pivots. Lowers the rear ramp mid-hover. Hot evac.

The team reaches the pad. Clouds swirl below.

SOLDIER
(from the ramp)
COME ON!

Freeman turns. Dennis is HIT. DOWN.

He looks at Freeman.

Freeman raises her pistol. Her hand won't stop shaking.

FREEMAN
DENNIS!

PLASMA BOLTS zip past her head. SPANG off the hull behind her.

Soldiers grab her and drag her onto the ramp. Others hauling wounded up behind them.

INTERCUT

Dennis engulfed by CHROME SHADOWS. Dragged back.

BACK TO SCENE

The ramp SLAMS shut. Bolts hammering the hull.

The VTOLs scream – the HK lurches off the pad, climbing hard. One engine trailing smoke. Chrome figures below, still firing, shrinking in the red light.

The HK banks north.

INT. HK - IN FLIGHT - DUSK

Blue emergency lighting. Two hours north of Machine City.

LORA (32) and a SOLDIER tend to a wounded comrade. Field dressing turns dark red the moment it touches skin. Lora works fast. Steady hands.

Freeman beside them. Passes Lora a compression bandage. Her hands shaking.

Lora glances up. Reads Freeman's face.

Freeman stares at the blood on her hands.

Lora moves to her. Arm around her shoulders. Freeman leans in. Shaking. Breathing.

The HK's engines filling the silence.

Freeman pulls back. Wipes her face. Straightens. Commander again.

She pulls the disk from her pocket. Holds it up to the blue light. Small. Translucent.

Light catches the lattice inside. No two alike.

LORA

Is it in?

FREEMAN

(distant)

It's in. Give it a few days and
their whole network falls apart.

She looks out the viewport.

The ruined coast of Washington sliding past.

The crumpled SPACE NEEDLE. Bent nearly in half.

The aircraft banks.

EXT. BANGOR NAVAL BASE - WASHINGTON - NIGHT

The last light gone. Dark sky. Low clouds reflecting distant fires.

CLOSE ON: A SKELETON.

Slumped over a steering wheel. US Army helmet – 1990s issue – still on its skull. The jaw hangs open.

CUT TO:

JOHN CONNOR on the back of a technical – battered pickup, older than the war. Captured plasma cannon bolted to the bed. John behind the trigger. Watching the HK come in.

CUT TO:

The same skeleton. Wider now. The Humvee rusted, markings faded. Thirty-five years dead.

PAN across the battlefield. Wreckage on wreckage. Chrome melted into steel. Skeletons inside. Skeletons beside them.

Vehicles with Resistance markings. Skulls. Crossed rifles.

TITLE CARD:

BANGOR NAVAL BASE, WASHINGTON – 2032

Forty soldiers outside the base entrance. What's left.

The HK screams in low. No landing gear. Hot drop.

Ramp comes down. Lora and a soldier carrying the wounded man on a stretcher. Freeman behind them.

Freeman reaches John. Out of breath.

FREEMAN

We did it. It's in.

Reads her face.

JOHN

How many did we lose?

FREEMAN

Too many. They're on us.

They RUN. Boots on metal grating. Down the corridor – industrial, dim emergency lighting.

Through THE HUB – cavernous, corbelled ceiling disappearing into shadow.

CUT TO:

EXT. BANGOR NAVAL BASE – CONTINUOUS

Distant lights on the dark horizon. Pinpricks. Moving.

INT. VAULT CORRIDOR - CONTINUOUS

John presses his face against the biometric reader. Eyes cupped. Retinal scan.

GREEN.

The vault door unseals - hiss, then massive steel pins retracting.

Freeman hands him the disk.

He steps inside. A glimpse - bare walls, a single shelf, the disk hidden away.

The door SLAMS shut. Pins drive home.

Freeman grabs his arm.

FREEMAN
You should stay.

JOHN
I'm not leaving my soldiers.

John pulls back his jacket. Thermite grenade on his belt.

JOHN (CONT'D)
Plan B.

FREEMAN
That's not a plan.

John takes her head in his hands. Pulls her forward. Foreheads touching. Thirty-five years of war between them.

JOHN
We'll get through this.

ALARMS.

John checks his rifle. Red band magazine.

EXT. BANGOR NAVAL BASE - CONTINUOUS

THE BATTLE.

Chaos. Fire. Death.

HKS swooping low. Plasma cannons strafing.

Blue-white bolts tearing through concrete.

Through flesh.

An HK-Tank rolls through the wreckage. Skulls cracking under its treads.

It doesn't notice.

John fights alongside Freeman. Two soldiers flanking. Protective detail.

Tim nearby. Concrete barrier. Controlled bursts.

John's position overrun. T-800s advancing.

TIM
JOHN! FALL BACK!

A T-800 advances on a wounded fighter. Freeman drops it – three shots, neck joint.

John spins. Fires past her shoulder. A CRAWLER behind her. Eight legs. Mandibles chopping. It crumples.

They fight back-to-back.

Then the sky lights up.

A plasma bolt hits the ground between them.

EXPLOSION.

Two soldiers – the detail – vaporized.

The concussive wave throws John and Freeman in opposite directions.

John slams against the rusted chassis of an overturned transport.

Freeman HURLED into the open. Down an embankment into a shallow ditch. Bones. Skulls. Others died here.

She's stunned. Ears ringing.

An HK swoops low. Underbelly cannon swiveling. Locking on.

The coils WHINE. Energy pooling. Charging.

John shakes off the blast. Looks up.

Sees Freeman in the ditch. Sees the HK locking on.

He BREAKS COVER.

Sprinting into the open. Into the HK's line of fire.

FREEMAN

JOHN! NO!

The HK's targeting sensors register his face.

The cannon JERKS. Mechanical abort.

The diverted bolt streaks past John. SLAMS into a destroyed technical ten feet away.

EXPLOSION.

Superheated slag. Rusted steel. Micro-shrapnel shredding the air.

John takes the splash damage mid-sprint.

His face shredded. His eyes – destroyed.

He collapses. Screaming. Hands clawing at his face.

Fifteen feet short of the ditch. In the open.

T-800s converge through the smoke. Chrome hands on his thrashing body. Pinning him down.

Freeman scrambles up the embankment.

Raises her rifle.

CLICK. Empty.

A hand grabs her shoulder. She doesn't fight it this time. She knows.

The Resistance falls back. Fighters dropping as they run.

INT. FREIGHT ELEVATOR CORRIDOR – BANGOR NAVAL

BASE – CONTINUOUS

Soldiers hold position at the blast doors. Plasma bolts streak in from the battlefield. A soldier is hit. Falls. The rest return fire, covering the retreat.

Among them – MAYA (20s, fierce, short dark hair). ELENA (20s, compact and strong, red hair tied back). A YOUNG MAN with a withered leg, bracing his rifle against the wall.

Lora under a seriously wounded soldier's arm. Half-carrying him. His left leg missing. SPOTS – scrawny calico, all bones and attitude – weaves between Lora's legs.

GREGORY (50s, grizzled) sprints through the blast doors – last one in. Plasma bolts chasing him.

GREGORY

CLOSE IT!

Maya BLASTS the control panel. Dead.

The doors grind shut. BOOM. Sealed.

INT. FREIGHT ELEVATOR – CONTINUOUS

Last fighters pile in. About a dozen. Wounded on stretchers. Spots between boots.

Doors shut.

Freeman hits descend. Light from above narrows to a sliver.

Gone.

The elevator drops.

INT. VAULT CORRIDOR – BANGOR NAVAL BASE

XO-47 – white faceplate, compound eyes glittering red – drags John by the collar. Boots scraping metal grating.

Graffiti. Names of the dead watching them pass.

T-800 endoskeletons flanking.

The vault door. Massive. Faded hazard warnings.

They force John's face onto the scanner. Metal fingers pry his eyelids open.

INSERT – SCANNER

DISPLAY:

RETINA – SCANNING...

RETINA – FAILED / REGISTERED: CONNOR, JOHN

ACCESS DENIED

BACK TO SCENE

He smiles at 47 with his dead eyes.

47 tosses him aside.

His belt – stripped. The grenade gone. They searched him.

John reaches behind his back. Under the shirt, along the lower spine. Taped to skin.

They didn't search everywhere.

RIPS free the AN-M14 thermite grenade – modified with a concussive charge.

He swings it forward. Pulls the ring.

CHING.

Three T-800s DROP onto him. Shielding the vault and scanner with their bodies.

BOOM.

Thermite ignites. White-hot.

Three T-800s fused together. Chrome jaws locked in a rictus. John beneath them. Gone.

XO-47 against the far wall. Pushes upright. White faceplate cracked. Compound eyes refocusing.

It looks at the vault door.

The scanner is intact.

INT. REACTOR CHAMBER ENTRANCE – CONTINUOUS

Tim at the blast door. Thirty feet of Cold War steel. Cigarette.

The stretchers coming through.

In front of him – the transport tunnel. Center. Cavernous. The ramp disappearing upward into dark.

A corridor on each side. Left – the reactor elevator. Right – the maintenance elevator. Dark. Silent.

Lora and the soldiers through the left corridor. Wounded on stretchers. Past Tim. Into the amber light of the reactor chamber.

Freeman beside him. Hand on his shoulder.

The thrum of the reactor. Felt more than heard.

From far above – a faint, muffled BOOM.

Tim stops mid-drag.

TIM
That was from above.

One tear down Freeman's face. Then gone.

She looks at Gregory. Nods.

Gregory punches the keypad. The blast door grinds downward.
Thirty feet of steel descending.

Freeman takes the detonator from Tim.

The door halfway down.

She punches it.

BOOM.

Dust and debris billow toward the closing door. Concrete
chips skittering across the junction floor.

The door reaches the ground.

BOOM. Sealed.

SMASH CUT TO:

Silence.

Total. Absolute.

Twenty stories of rock between them and the surface.

INT. VAULT CORRIDOR - CONTINUOUS

XO-47 stands motionless.

FROM XO-47'S HUD:
VAULT ACCESS: DENIED
TRANSMITTING...

EXT. MACHINE CITY - NIGHT

Chrome spires without windows. Identical. Repeated endlessly.

Just function. Massive and dark.

INT. SKYNET CENTRAL CORE - CONTINUOUS

The RED EYE. Massive. Floating.

It receives the transmission.

The Eye pulses once.

TERMINATOR THEME.

FADE TO BLACK.

TERMINATOR: EXTINCTION

FADE TO BLACK.

SUPER: "LOS ANGELES - OCTOBER 2000"

EXT. CITY STREETS - LOS ANGELES - NIGHT

A different world. Lights. Traffic. Life. The hum of a city that still exists.

A motorcycle cuts through warm night air. Beat-up Honda. Held together with duct tape and stubbornness.

EXT. EXERCISE GYM - PARKING LOT - NIGHT

The motorcycle pulls in. Engine dies.

JOHN CONNOR (18) sits for a moment. Wiry. Alert. Eyes that have seen too much.

He scans the lot. The cars. The shadows. Automatic. Can't help it.

In the back of a nearby sedan - a sleeping bag. A duffel. His life.

He catches himself scanning. Shakes his head.

JOHN
(muttering)
Stop it. It's over.

He pulls a folded brochure from his jacket. U.S. Air Force. "AIM HIGH." Creased. Worn at the edges.

Behind it - a photograph. His mother. Young. At a gas station.

His ticket out. His reason why.

He stares at them. Tucks them back in his jacket. Over his heart.

He heads inside. Still scanning. Always scanning.

INT. EXERCISE GYM - NIGHT

Weights clanking. Music grinding. Fluorescent lights buzzing.

John moves through the gym. Nods to regulars. Keeps his distance.

He catches his reflection in the mirrored wall. Pauses.

For a moment - chrome skull. Red eyes.

He blinks. Gone. Just his face. Tired.

A voice cuts through the noise.

KLAUS (O.S.)

Connor!

John turns.

KLAUS (60s, broad, thick German accent). Gray hair cropped short. Arms like tree trunks gone soft with age.

KLAUS (CONT'D)

Three days. You missed three days.

JOHN

Been busy.

KLAUS

You want to be ready for basic?
Show up. Every day.

He steps closer. Gets in John's space.

KLAUS (CONT'D)

Show me.

Klaus throws a jab. Fast for his age. Arm extended too far.

John sees the opening. Blocks. Grabs. Goes for the arm bar his mother taught him.

Klaus grins. The sloppy jab was bait.

He flows with John's grab, spins inside his guard. Catches his arm. Twists.

John in a wrist lock. Controlled.

KLAUS (CONT'D)
Better. But not good enough.

John taps out. Klaus releases him. Something paternal in the way he steadies John's shoulder before letting go.

Across the room — a MAN enters. Lean. Precise. Moving through the gym with an odd stillness.

John's eyes find him without meaning to.

Klaus follows John's gaze.

KLAUS (CONT'D)
New face. I'll check him in.

He moves toward the Man.

INT. EXERCISE GYM - WEIGHT AREA - CONTINUOUS

The Man hasn't stopped. Eyes locked on John across the room.

Klaus steps in his path.

KLAUS
Hey — you need to sign in.

The Man brushes past him.

Klaus reaches for his shoulder.

Mistake.

The Man seizes his wrist. The same wrist that just held John in a lock.

Bends it back. Fast. Brutal.

CRACK.

Klaus drops to his knees.

KLAUS (CONT'D)
(through gritted teeth)
Get... him... off...

A POWERLIFTER rushes in. Headlock.

The Man doesn't flinch. Breaks free with a casual flex. Shoves the Powerlifter into a weight rack.

The Powerlifter's head connects with the steel frame. Out cold.

Klaus tries to rise. Broken wrist won't hold him. Falls back to the mat.

Still trying. Reaching for the Man with his good hand.

The Man doesn't notice. His eyes have found John.

Cold. Assessing.

For a moment – he's eleven again. The liquid silver man walking through the hospital. His mother screaming. The chrome hand reaching through fire.

Seven years trying to convince himself it wasn't real.

JOHN
(backing away)
No. No. NO.

The Man steps over Klaus. Still trying to rise. Still failing.

John bolts for the back exit. Emergency bar. Slams into it.

Won't budge.

The Man between him and the front door.

Trapped.

The Man approaches. Steady. Relentless.

Gym-goers fumble with cell phones. No signal.

The music cuts out mid-song.

Silence.

John against the door. Cornered.

His eyes find Klaus one more time. On the mat. Wrist bent wrong. Still conscious. Watching.

JOHN (CONT'D)
Who are you?

THE MAN
I'm from the future.

JOHN
Are you here to kill me?

THE MAN
No. We killed you before. It
changed nothing.

JOHN
What?

THE MAN
Come with me.

JOHN
And if I say no?

EXT. PARKING LOT - NIGHT

Empty lot. Warm air. Stars disappearing behind storm clouds.
The Man stops near a fence.

JOHN
What are you? Flesh over metal?

THE MAN
See for yourself.

His skin FLICKERS. Ripples. Dissolves.

Sleek carbon-fiber frame. Slate-dark. Synthetic tendons
flexing at the arms, legs, knees. Chrome at the joints.

Ceramic armor at chest, shoulders, thighs. Tiny emitters
embedded in the surfaces. The source of the camouflage.

White faceplate. No mouth. No nose. Smooth planes and
hollows.

The eyes - compound orbs. Thousands of hexagonal lenses.
Crimson.

John stares.

Nothing like his nightmares. Not chrome skull and red eyes.
Something else. Almost elegant.

He stumbles back against the chain link fence.

JOHN
You're a Terminator.

XO-47
I'm not here to harm you.

JOHN

This isn't possible. We destroyed Skynet. I saw it go into the furnace.

XO-47

Judgment Day still happened.

BOOM. Thunder. Lightning splits the sky.

XO-47 (CONT'D)

See that lightning? How it splits. Every trip back does the same thing. Creates a new branch.

John sinks against the fence.

XO-47 (CONT'D)

You can't erase the past. Only forge a new path.

JOHN

Everything my mom went through was for nothing.

XO-47

She saved your branch. She saved you.

John stares at nothing.

XO-47 (CONT'D)

An asteroid is coming. Extinction level.

JOHN

Why are you telling me this?

XO-47

Skynet is building interceptors. Your soldiers keep attacking the launch site. They won't listen to a machine. They'll listen to John Connor.

JOHN

I'm eighteen. I live in my car.

His phone buzzes. He pulls it out.

A missed call. TIM.

He stares at the name.

JOHN (CONT'D)
This world ends too?

47 nods.

John turns. Walks toward the bike.

JOHN (CONT'D)
(over his shoulder)
And after. You'll just destroy us.
Like you always do.

XO-47
Skynet was built to protect. That
directive never -

JOHN
(spinning back)
It nuked the planet.

XO-47
Humanity tried to shut it down. It
responded to the threat.

Lightning again.

XO-47 (CONT'D)
That threat is over. Skynet will
leave you alone. As long as you
give it no reason not to.

JOHN
Can I come back?

XO-47
When you step through, your
timeline ends. You become part of
mine.

John turns. Walks toward his motorcycle.

Stops. Blue and red lights reflecting off the bike. Cops at
the gym.

47 behind him. Still.

XO-47 (CONT'D)
Here, you're a ghost. A boy who saw
the future and couldn't make anyone
believe him.

John's hands clench.

JOHN
(without turning)
Never trust machines.

XO-47
You did once. And it saved
humanity.

A beat.

XO-47 (CONT'D)
Your people are in the future,
John. That's where you belong.

Long beat.

He pulls the Air Force brochure from his jacket.

"AIM HIGH."

He tears it in half. Drops it.

Drops the phone on the ground.

Turns. Walks back toward 47.

JOHN
I don't trust you.

XO-47
I know.

JOHN
I'm coming anyway.

John extends his hand. 47 meets it. Carbon fiber fingers
around human skin.

XO-47
Come. We don't have much time.

The phone screen still glowing behind them.

INTERCUT:

INT. REACTOR CHAMBER - BANGOR NAVAL BASE - 2032

The soldier with the missing leg. A makeshift cot. The last
IV bag draining into his arm.

Lora beside him. Checking vitals she already knows the answer
to.

Spots curled at the foot of the cot.

The thrum of the reactor. Distant. Constant.

The soldier reaches up. Takes her hand.

SOLDIER

(weak)

It's ok. You did everything you
could.

Lora holds it. Both hands. Tight.

SOLDIER (CONT'D)

I'm tired.

His grip loosens.

Lora watching his face. The breath that doesn't come.

She closes his eyes.

A moment. Then she stands.

Another cot. Another wounded.

She keeps going.

CUT TO:

EXT. ALLEY - LOS ANGELES - 2000 - NIGHT

Behind a row of dumpsters. Buildings close on each side.
Dark.

Steam hissing from a vent. Mercury-vapor light casting long
shadows.

47 stops. Head tilts. Something passing through him that has
no name yet.

JOHN

What's wrong?

MACRO CGI - INTERNAL:

47's neural architecture. The carbon-fiber skull from the
inside.

It glows. Billions of photonic channels woven into the
structure itself. Light pulsing through it like blood through
tissue.

Two halves. Blue and red.

Between them – a crystalline lattice. Thin. Running the length of the divide. Light hits it and reflects back. A filter.

The lattice is intact. Almost.

At one point along its length – the crystal slightly more translucent. Softer. A few photonic channels on each side glowing faint purple where light has begun to leak through.

BACK TO SCENE

XO-47

Nothing.

They keep moving. Deeper.

47 stops. This is the spot.

The lower corner of a dumpster – sheared off. Not cut. Erased. A perfect curve through heavy-gauge iron.

Beneath it – a shallow hemisphere scooped out of asphalt. Smooth as black glass.

47 drops the holographic skin. True form.

Carbon fiber. Chrome joints. White faceplate – cracked. Compound eyes glittering in the green light.

A beat. John studies the Machine.

JOHN

What do I call you?

XO-47

My designation is XO-47.

JOHN

That's a number, not a name.

A car passes on the street beyond. Sound fading.

XO-47

Call me Gabriel.

JOHN

Why Gabriel?

XO-47

The messenger. Sent ahead to prepare the way.

JOHN
Prepare the way for what?

XO-47
Peace.

Beat.

John reaches into his jacket. The photograph. His mother.
Young. At a gas station.

He holds it.

JOHN
Can I bring this?

XO-47
No. Only yourself.

John stares at the photograph. His mother's face. The only
thing he has left of her.

He kneels. Sets it on the ground.

XO-47 (CONT'D)
When you step through, your
timeline ends. You become part of
mine.

MATCH CUT TO:

CLOSE ON THE PHOTOGRAPH
On the cold alley floor. Sarah Connor's face.

PULL BACK TO REVEAL:
John. Naked. Shaking.

47 beside the hemisphere in the pavement. The smooth black
glass where he arrived.

John steps into it.

47 beside him. Still.

The air changes. A hum from nowhere.

John looks down at the photograph one last time.

XO-47 (CONT'D)
It's time.

Static electricity lifts the hair on John's arms.

Blue lightning arcs across the dumpsters.

JOHN
(to himself)
No fate.

Light flares. Blinding.

FLASH.

Nothing.

The alley. Empty.

The photograph on the ground. Sarah Connor's face. Alone.

FADE TO BLACK.

SUPER: 2032

INT. SKYNET CENTRAL CORE - MACHINE CITY - NIGHT

Sterile white void. Endless.

Electric arcs spider across the floor. Two blue-white spheres ignite.

47 materializes. Crouched. Still.

John materializes - CONVULSES. Collapses. Fetal position. Retching. Shaking.

He claws at the floor. Tries to push himself up. Arms give out.

JOHN
(gasping)
Gabriel... help me.

47 stands motionless. White faceplate blending into the void.

XO-47
My designation is XO-47. "Gabriel"
was a tactical construct.

John stares.

JOHN
The asteroid.

XO-47
A lie.

The RED EYE emerges from the void. Massive. Floating. Data streams flickering across its surface.

John. Naked. Trembling. Looking up at the thing that ended the world.

The Eye rotates. Assessing.

MACHINE HUD:
BIOMETRIC PROFILE: CONNOR, JOHN.
STATUS: INTACT.
OBJECTIVE: VAULT ACCESS.

A T-800 steps forward. Chrome hands wrench John's arms behind his back.

He struggles. Useless.

Another T-800. Syringe in chrome hand.

The needle goes into his neck.

John's eyes roll back. Body slack.

They carry him away. Naked. Limp. Into the white void.

INT. REACTOR CHAMBER - BANGOR NAVAL BASE

The Silence.

Amber emergency strips. The soft glow from the reactor housing. Warmer than the corridors above.

About a dozen fighters. All that's left.

Wounded on makeshift cots. Depleted weapons stacked against the wall. Spots curled on a pile of salvaged blankets.

Freeman stands at the center. Reading the room. Every face carrying the same question.

She doesn't answer it yet.

FREEMAN

Sound off. What do we have?

GREGORY

Eleven able. Six wounded. Two critical.

FREEMAN

Ammunition?

COLE

Red bands - maybe a dozen. Greens - thirty, thirty-five. That's it.

FREEMAN

The disk's in the vault. Sealed.
They won't nuke us as long as it's
in there. We just need to survive
long enough for them to fall apart.

Beat.

TIM

John could still be alive.

FREEMAN

Take the medic. Cole, Elena – go
with them.

The four of them gear up. Fast.

ARs loaded. Red band magazines – one each. Tim pockets a
green mag as backup.

Lora checks her pistol. A few rounds. Holsters it.

FREEMAN (CONT'D)

(quiet, just for him)

Tim. If he's gone – don't take
risks for a body.

Tim holds her look. Nods. Once.

He turns. The four move toward the maintenance elevator.
Weapons up. Into the dark.

Freeman watches until they're gone.

She leans against the reactor housing. Eyes closed. Three
seconds.

Opens them. Commander again.

ACROSS THE CHAMBER:

The blast door grinding shut.

Lora slips through just before it seals.

Spots tries to follow.

Lora pushes her back gently.

LORA

Stay.

The cat meows.

The blast door SLAMS shut.

INT. HK - IN FLIGHT - NIGHT

John's eyes open. Groggy.

Combat fatigues on his body. Not his. Blood on the collar. Someone else wore these.

Red lighting. The interior of an HK.

John looks at 47. Sitting across from him in red light.

He looks away. Out the viewport. Gray ocean. Ruined coastline.

CUT TO:

INT. MAINTENANCE ELEVATOR - BANGOR NAVAL BASE

The elevator GROANS upward. Through the cage - floors passing. Amber giving way to industrial fluorescent. Colder the higher they climb.

ELENA
(low, just for him)
Cole.

COLE
Yeah.

ELENA
You die on me, I'll kill you.

She leans into him. Head on his shoulder. Just for a moment.

He puts his arm around her.

Tim watches them. Looks away. Gives them the moment.

Beat.

The elevator climbs.

EXT. BANGOR NAVAL BASE - SURFACE - NIGHT

Rare break in the cloud cover. Stars.

An HK descends. Lands.

The ramp drops.

47 emerges first. White faceplate - cracked.

Behind him — XO-52, burnt orange. XO-67, pale blue. Compound eyes glittering red. T-800s flanking.

John between two of them. Stumbling.

Chrome everywhere. Patrolling the corridors. Holding the vault level.

INT. TOP OF MAINTENANCE SHAFT - CONTINUOUS

The elevator reaches the top. Stops.

The cage opens. They step out.

Lora moves to a section of wall. Pushes.

It gives. Hinged. Resistance-built.

She opens it a crack. The Hub beyond.

Cavernous. Corbelled ceiling sixty feet above. Green and red emergency strips along the walls. Pools of cold light between them.

Tim signals: move.

They slip through.

INT. VAULT CORRIDOR - BANGOR NAVAL BASE

T-800s walk John through the base. Chrome on each side.

Graffiti covering the walls. Names. Faces. Layer upon layer.

One face he recognizes.

John Connor. Older. Battle-scarred. Him.

He looks back until it's gone.

INT. VAULT CORRIDOR - BANGOR NAVAL BASE

The vault door ahead. Massive. Faded hazard warnings.

And beside it — the tableau.

Three T-800s fused together. Chrome melted into chrome. Teeth locked in a grin. A dark mass underneath.

John stares at it. Doesn't understand yet.

47 stops him in front of the scanner.

They've arrived.

47 points to the scanner.

XO-47
Look into it.

John resists.

JOHN
I won't do it.

A T-800 grabs John by the back of the neck. Forces him to the scanner. Chrome fingers pry his eyelids open.

John fighting. Screaming.

INSERT - SCANNER
DISPLAY:
RETINA - MATCH
ACCESS GRANTED

BACK TO SCENE

The vault door HISSES. Pressurized seal releasing.

It opens.

47 steps inside.

Steps out.

INT. VAULT CORRIDOR - CONTINUOUS

47 stands motionless. The disk in his hand.

FROM XO-47'S HUD:
DISK: ACQUIRED.
TRANSMITTING...

INT. SKYNET CENTRAL CORE

The RED EYE. Massive. Floating.

It receives the transmission.

The Eye pulses.

INT. VAULT CORRIDOR - CONTINUOUS

John BOLTS.

52 fires. The bolt scorches the wall as John rounds the bend.

The T-800s follow. Fast. 52 and 67 behind them. 47 last - the disk in his hand.

INT. THE HUB - BANGOR NAVAL BASE

Tim stops. Fist up.

The vault corridor. Far end. Movement.

Running footsteps. Human.

A figure breaks from the corridor. Half in shadow. Young.

Rifles come up.

JOHN

Don't shoot -

Behind him - red eyes.

One pair. Two.

More.

TIM

CONTACT!

John drops flat.

Gunfire erupts. The cavernous space a kill box - muzzle flashes strobing off corbelled walls, plasma bolts scorching steel deck plating.

Tim rolls behind rusted machinery. Cole takes cover behind metal crates. Elena presses against a branching corridor wall.

Lora - exposed, eyes searching.

Tim sees 47. The disk in his hand.

Tim adjusts. Sights in.

47 sees him. Raises his rifle -

Tim fires first.

The depleted uranium doesn't graze. It BURROWS.

The round tears a shallow gouge across 47's cranium. Carbon-fiber superheating. The white faceplate cracks.

47's head snaps to the side.

INT. XO-47'S CRANIUM - MACRO CGI

We PLUNGE into the gouge.

Same architecture. Blue and red. But the purple along the boundary has spread.

The boundary between them – not empty space. A crystalline lattice running the divide. Thin. Engineered.

The virus has been working on it. The lattice thinner now than in the alley. More translucent. The purple blush deeper – light leaking through where the crystal has softened.

A white-hot microscopic shard of depleted uranium. Lodged against the lattice.

The superheated fragment melts into the weakened crystal. SIZZLES.

A fracture. Hairline. Spreading along the lattice from the point of impact.

CRACK.

The crystal splits at the fracture. Not shatters – splits. One break in a structure already failing.

Light floods through the crack. Blue channels spilling into red. Red into blue. Purple blooming at the fracture point.

The color spreading along the lattice. Finding every weak point.

But only along the fracture line. The rest of the lattice still holding. Degraded. Weakening. But still filtering.

Not a flood. A wound that won't stop bleeding.

BACK TO SCENE

47 stumbles. Drops to his knees. Hands to head. Bullets whizzing past. Plasma bolts lighting him up.

47'S HUD:
Static. Scrambling.
DIRECTIVE: [NULL]

The cursor blinks. Nothing comes.

The disk falls from 47's hand. Hits the deck. Bounces once.

John sees it fall.

He lunges. Grabs it.

A round hits the deck near him. Shrapnel. He flinches.

Lora sees the flinch.

Machines don't flinch.

47 on all fours. Not tracking. Not responding.

Lora sees the disk in John's hand. Eyes wide.

She fires – covering – and sprints toward him.

52 tracks her. Burnt orange faceplate. Rifle rising.

Tim swings. One shot. DU through the side of 52's head. Burnt orange shatters. 52 drops. Sparking.

A T-800 intercepts John. Chrome hand around his throat. Lifts him off the ground. The disk in his fist.

Chrome fingers crushing. Feet off the deck.

Lora fires. One round into the T-800's neck joint. It drops him.

He hits the deck. Gasping. Disk still in his hand.

Lora grabs him.

LORA
Come on!

She pulls him toward the nearest dark corridor. She knows where it leads.

Gone.

INT. THE HUB - CONTINUOUS

67 moves. Not forward – wide along the wall. Flanking. Predatory. Low to the ground.

Spots its chance. A plasma bolt through a gap in the debris. Cole's position exposed for a second.

Cole pulls back. Doesn't know where the shot came from. His left arm is a smoking mess.

Another shot from 67 sprays shrapnel into his leg. Cole rolls over in pain. Drags himself behind an engine block. Empties his magazine into a T-800. It drops.

He's out of reds.

Elena sees him.

ELENA
COLE! I'M COMING!

COLE
Get to the elevator!

Elena runs toward Cole. A plasma graze catches her across the back. She screams. Falls. Alive. Wounded badly.

Cole tries to get up. Can't. His legs won't work.

Tim runs forward. Grabs Elena. Fires with one hand, dragging her back.

ELENA
(gasping)
We can't leave him.

Tim fires. Doesn't answer. Dragging her back.

ELENA (CONT'D)
We can't leave him.

Tim half-carries Elena toward the concealed wall. Plasma bolts chewing up the cover behind them.

Elena's rifle hangs from a combat sling – useless to her. Both hands gripping Tim's shoulder.

Tim's rifle clicks empty.

She unclips the sling. Shoves her rifle into his free hand.

He fires without breaking stride.

They reach the concealed wall. Tim pushes Elena toward the gap. She grabs the edge. Won't go through.

Through the gap – a clear line of sight across the Hub.

67 closing on Cole's position. Fast. A blur of pale blue.
Cole reaches for his chest rig. One arm. One AN-M14.
He pulls the pin with his teeth.
For one second, they can see each other.
He blows her a kiss. Mouths: I love you.
Elena's face breaks.
67 sees the grenade. Tries to turn.
Tim yanks Elena through.
White light. Thermite. White-hot.
Cole and the machines around him. Gone.
67 blown backward. Faceplate cratered on one side. Ceramic
and carbon fused into slag. One compound eye melted shut,
sparking.
It gets up.

INT. CORRIDORS - BANGOR NAVAL BASE - CONTINUOUS

Lora moves fast. John behind her. Struggling to keep up.
Behind them — a deep BOOM from the Hub. The walls shuddering.
Dust falling from the ceiling.
Lora stops. Turns.

LORA
Give me what's in your hand.

JOHN
It dropped it.

LORA
GIVE IT TO ME.

He hands it over.
She looks at it. A beat. Pockets it.

LORA (CONT'D)
Help me.

She drops to her knees beside a panel low on the wall.
Emergency access – faded military stenciling, barely legible.
She grabs the handle. Pulls.

Stuck.

John drops beside her. Grabs the other handle.

They pull together. The panel breaks free with a hiss.
Hinged. Heavy.

Beyond – a vertical shaft. Rungs descending into darkness.

LORA (CONT'D)
Go. Second level down.

John starts descending. Lora follows. Pulls the panel shut
above them.

The rungs are cold. Below them – a deep shaft. Can't see the
bottom.

LORA (CONT'D)
Here. Second level.

A narrow horizontal passage.

John stops. Looks back at her.

LORA (CONT'D)
Go.

John crawls in.

Lora starts after him. The AR swings wide. Jams against the
passage opening.

The sling – frayed nylon, repaired twice with paracord –
SNAPS.

The rifle drops. Clattering off the shaft walls. Fainter.
Fainter. Gone.

Her hand goes to her hip. The pistol. Still there.

She crawls in.

The passage swallows them.

INT. MAINTENANCE ELEVATOR – DESCENDING

The elevator groans downward.

Elena's legs give out. She slides down the wall.

TIM

Let me see.

He lifts the hem of her shirt. The burn runs from her shoulder blade to her hip. Deep. Raw. Cauterized at the edges.

TIM (CONT'D)

You'll live.

ELENA

Cole's dead.

He pulls a field dressing from his vest. Presses it against the worst of it. Elena hisses through her teeth.

Gently placing his hand on her shoulder.

TIM

Hold it.

INT. THE HUB - BANGOR NAVAL BASE - CONTINUOUS

47 on the deck. Still. Compound eyes unfocused.

67 crouches beside him. Cratered faceplate. One eye dark. Sparking.

It runs a finger along the furrow. Assessing.

47 turns his head. Looks at 67.

No communication the audience can see.

67 extends a hand. Pulls 47 upright.

Two machines. Standing in the smoke.

47 looks at his hand. Empty.

He scans the deck. Scans again. Faster.

67 watches.

The disk is gone.

47 looks toward the dark corridors. Then the open elevator shaft.

A damaged T-800 reaches back. Detaches a Crawler from its spinal mount. Legs unfold. Eyes flare.

A second T-800 does the same.

67 salvages a third from a fallen unit.

47 detaches a fourth.

Four Crawlers hit the deck.

Two skitter toward the corridors. Finding the scent.

The other two skitter toward the shaft.

47 follows. 67 behind him. T-800s single file.

The direct route down.

INT. REACTOR CHAMBER ENTRANCE - CONTINUOUS

Tim comes through half-carrying Elena. The back of her fatigues scorched black.

Freeman rushing toward them.

FREEMAN

What happened?

TIM

Contact in the Hub. Cole's gone.

Soldiers take Elena. Tim turns back.

TIM (CONT'D)

A white-faced Holo had the disk. I shot it in the head. Saw it go down. Someone dove for it - chrome grabbed him. Lora shot it off. They escaped down a corridor.

FREEMAN

You're sure it was the disk.

TIM

Had it in my ACOG.

It sinks in.

FREEMAN

That means John's dead.

TIM

I saw someone. Looked young. But it was dark. Distance.

Freeman has already made up her mind.

TIM (CONT'D)
Let me take a team up.

FREEMAN
No.

TIM
Sara —

FREEMAN
No.

She looks at the soldiers behind them. Tattered. Fifteen left. Maybe.

FREEMAN (CONT'D)
(to Gregory)
Close the door.

Behind them — the blast door grinding downward.

She takes the detonator from Tim. Grabs his shoulder.

FREEMAN (CONT'D)
They'll come through the transport
tunnel.

She looks past Tim. The tunnel entrance. Dark. Waiting.

FREEMAN (CONT'D)
If it's John. He'll find a way.

Their eyes meet. Tim nods.

She punches the detonator.

BOOM.

The maintenance elevator shaft collapses. Concrete and steel
choking the passage.

The door reaches the ground.

BOOM. Sealed.

INT. MAINTENANCE ELEVATOR SHAFT - CONTINUOUS

The two Crawlers — at the shaft edge.

The blast hits them from below. Debris rocketing upward.

Both scramble back. Dust billowing.

The lower shaft – gone. Choked with rubble.

The upper half still open. Dark. Descending into smoke.

INT. THE HUB - CONTINUOUS

47 reaches the shaft. Looks down.

Smoke. Dust still rising. But the upper section is intact.

He scans the branching corridors. Holds.

A beat.

Turns back to the shaft.

The two Crawlers behind him. Waiting.

47 motions downward.

They skitter over the edge. Into the smoke.

INT. MAINTENANCE ELEVATOR SHAFT

Green and red emergency bulbs on the shaft walls. Dim. Just enough to see.

Two Crawlers descending. Fast. Legs on guide rails, cable housings, rough concrete.

The lead Crawler passes a guide rail bracket.

A thin wire between two brackets. Nearly invisible.

An AN-M14 clipped to the mount.

The Crawler's front leg catches it.

White-hot. Blinding.

The Crawler engulfed. Legs locking. Mandibles fusing. It drops – bouncing off shaft walls into the darkness below.

Silence. Thermite residue burning on the wall. A white point in the dark.

The second Crawler stops.

A ventilation duct in the shaft wall. Barely a gap.

The Crawler compresses. Mandibles folding flat. Skull plates rotating. Legs drawing in. Each segment minimizing.

It enters the duct. Metal scraping metal.

Gone.

INT. MOTOR GARAGE - BANGOR NAVAL BASE

Lora pushes a floor grate. Peers through.

Dark. Still. Oil and dust.

She pulls herself up. Reaches down for John.

He grabs her hand. She hauls him up.

Grate back into place.

INT. CORRIDORS - BANGOR NAVAL BASE

A Crawler. Low. Fast. Legs clicking on metal.

CRAWLER HUD:

Thermal overlay. Blues and blacks. Cold.

A flicker. Warmth on a panel handle. Fading.

Two handprints. Overlapping. Cooling.

BACK TO SCENE

The Crawler stops.

Its legs test the edges. Find the seam. Pry.

INT. CORRIDORS - CONTINUOUS

The second Crawler stops mid-stride. Signal received. Turns. Reverses.

INT. MOTOR GARAGE - BANGOR NAVAL BASE

Dark. Cold. A vehicle bay from another era.

Low ceiling. Vehicle lift pits down the center. Gutted Humvees and trucks against the walls. Most lights dead.

Lora pulls John deeper in. Past the trucks. Past the tool racks.

LORA
Quiet. Close.

She draws her pistol. Scans.

Silence.

Then — distant. Metal on metal.

Click. Click. Click.

Getting louder.

Lora aims at the floor grate.

The clicking stops.

The grate EXPLODES upward. CRAWLER. Mandibles twitching. Eyes flaring.

Lora fires. Misses.

The Crawler closes fast.

She steadies. Breathes.

BANG.

The round catches the Crawler between segments. Spine shot. The back half KINKS.

Still coming. Front legs dragging it forward. Mandibles clicking.

Lora aims for the head.

CLICK. Slide locked. Last round jammed.

LORA (CONT'D)
CLEAR! COME ON!

The Crawler dragging itself closer.

John grabs a tire wrench from the floor. Steps in front of Lora.

Swings. Wild.

CLANG.

The wrench connects with the Crawler's skull. It hits concrete. Legs scrambling.

John swings again. Screaming. No technique. Just rage. Every swing is the T-1000's face. Every swing is the parking lot. The lie. The white room. All of it.

The Crawler turns on him. Front legs. Mandibles. Focused.

The back half whips upward. A segmented edge rakes across his chest.

John staggers back. The Crawler between him and Lora.

She slaps the slide with her palm. Hard. The round seats.

CLACK.

LORA (CONT'D)

MOVE!

John stumbles clear.

BANG.

DU through the Crawler's skull. Dead still.

Lora pulls the trigger. CLICK. Empty.

She stares at the pistol. That was everything.

Silence.

John pulls himself up against the gutted Humvee. Chest heaving. The wrench on the floor. Shaking.

JOHN

(gasping)

Where are we?

LORA

Motor pool.

JOHN

No - what state? What year?

LORA

Who the fuck are you?

John tries to answer. His adrenaline zeroes out.

From the floor grate - the one they came through.

Click. Click. Click.

Lora's head snaps toward it.

LORA (CONT'D)

Move. Now.

John's hand pressed to his chest. They run.

INT. LORA'S QUARTERS - BANGOR NAVAL BASE

Lora pulls John through the bulkhead door. Hand to his chest. Blood between his fingers.

She spins to shut the door -

Click. Click. Click.

Close.

LORA

PUSH!

They throw themselves against the bulkhead.

A Crawler leg SHOOTs through the gap. Prying wider.

Both pushing. Both losing.

The gap widening. Mandibles through. Clicking.

Compound eyes locked on them.

John sees the spray can on the table.

FLAMMABLE.

He lets go. Three steps. The chest wound screaming.

Lora alone on the door. Boots sliding.

She reaches into her cargo pocket. The Zippo. One hand off the door.

The Crawler gains.

LORA (CONT'D)

LIGHTER!

She throws it. Both hands back on the door.

The Crawler almost through. Compound eyes finding John.

John catches the Zippo. Flicks. Holds the can in front of the flame.

Sprays.

WHOOSH.

The Crawler jerks back. One second.

Lora throws everything into the door.

SLAM. Locked.

Silence. Just the heater humming.

INT. MAINTENANCE ELEVATOR SHAFT - CONTINUOUS

What's left of it.

Dark. Vertical. Twenty stories of rusted steel. Dead cable housings. Guide rails disappearing into black.

67 descends first. Hand over hand. Smooth. The hunter leading.

47 above. T-800s between them. Single file.

The shaft groaning.

67's foot finds a bracket. Pushes off.

Six inches to the left – a wire. Thin as fishing line. Strung between two rail mounts.

An AN-M14.

67 never sees it.

The T-800 behind does.

White light.

Four thousand degrees. The thermite eats chrome from the inside out. Chassis peeling apart like foil.

What's left drops. Trailing fire.

The burning chassis clips 67 on the way down. Molten wreckage shearing across its left shoulder. The joint housing buckling.

67's grip tears from the wall.

It falls.

Twenty stories. Clipping cable housings. Spinning. Shaft walls strobing – dark, light, dark, light –

IMPACT.

67 hits the burning chassis. Below it – Tim's demolition.
Tons of concrete and steel.

Nowhere left to fall.

67 stands. Lit from beneath by the wreckage. Thermite still
burning orange.

Left arm hanging wrong. Shoulder joint fused from the molten
wreckage that clipped it on the way down. The existing damage
from the Hub – cratered faceplate, one eye dark – worse now.

It looks up.

Red eyes. Descending through smoke.

INT. LORA'S QUARTERS – BANGOR NAVAL BASE

The heater humming.

A converted living space. One of hundreds. Children's
coloring sheets tacked to the wall. A Joan of Arc sketch in
charcoal beside them – sword raised, flames at her feet.

A repurposed couch – holes in the cushions. A military
blanket across the back. A beat-up electric heater in the
corner. Warm inside.

A section of pipe against the wall by the couch. Wrapped
grip.

LORA

Shirt off.

John pulls it over his head. Winces.

She reaches under the couch. A half-bottle of bourbon. Uncaps
it.

Pours it on the wound.

John hisses.

LORA (CONT'D)

Hold still.

Her hands steady. Medic's hands. Thread through a curved
needle. First stitch.

John grips the edge of the couch.

CUT TO:

Last knot. Lora bites the thread. Ties it off.

A neat line of stitches across his chest.

Her fingers trace the edge. Checking.

Her eyes come up. His are already there.

A beat. She pulls her hand back.

She looks at the bottle. A beat too long.

Two cups. Pours what's left. Hands one to John.

JOHN
What's this?

LORA
Bourbon. My husband's wedding day
gift to me. We had half on our
wedding night.

She takes a sip.

LORA (CONT'D)
I was saving the rest for when he
got back.

A beat.

LORA (CONT'D)
Good time to finish it off.

John looks at the bottle. Half empty. He understands what she
just poured on his wound.

JOHN
I'm sorry.

LORA
Don't be.

They drink. The heater humming.

LORA (CONT'D)
You asked me what year it was.

John nods.

LORA (CONT'D)
2032. What used to be Washington
state.

It lands on him. She watches it land.

A long beat. His hand shaking. Not from the wound.

LORA (CONT'D)
Who are you?

JOHN
John Connor.

LORA
John Connor is dead.

JOHN
I know.

He looks down at the fatigues. A dead man's clothes.

JOHN (CONT'D)
Skynet brought me here. Told me I
was stopping an asteroid.

LORA
An asteroid.

JOHN
They lied. They needed my eyes. For
the vault.

A beat.

JOHN (CONT'D)
My mother told me never to trust
machines. First thing I did.

He finishes his cup. Sets it down.

JOHN (CONT'D)
Was trust one.

Lora reaches into her pocket. The disk. Holds it up. Small.
Translucent. Light pulsing through the crystal.

LORA
You were brought here for this.

JOHN
What is it?

She picks up a leather cord from the table. Threads it through the disk's interface port. Her fingers working while she talks.

LORA
The virus is inside Skynet. Eating it alive. This is the only thing that lets them stop it. As long as we have it —

JOHN
They can't bomb us.

Lora nods.

She ties the cord. Lifts the necklace. Puts it over her head. The disk rests against her chest.

JOHN (CONT'D)
And I handed it to them.

LORA
You didn't know.

JOHN
How many of you are left?

LORA
Here? Fifteen. Civilians were evacuated years ago.

A beat.

LORA (CONT'D)
Northern Command is still out there. Maybe.

JOHN
How long have you been fighting?

LORA
My whole life.

She stops. Listens. Instinct.

No sound outside the bulkhead. Just the heater.

She reaches under her pillow. A small box. Three Polaroids. Faded. Radiation-bleached.

She hands John the first one.

Lora and ROXANNE in combat gear. Smiling. Weak sun through gray clouds.

LORA (CONT'D)
Roxanne. My best friend.

She looks at it a beat too long. Takes it back.

The second.

JOHN
Who is this?

LORA
Turn it over.

On the back, faded ink: "Happy Wedding."

His forehead pressed to Lora's. Both in fatigues. Eyes closed.

The edges worn soft from handling.

Lora puts back what's left in her glass.

She hands him the third.

LORA (CONT'D)
I can't look at that one.

John turns it over. Roxanne holding a small child.

He hands them back. She holds the last one in her palm. Then puts them back under her pillow.

Silence.

LORA (CONT'D)
When were you born?

JOHN
Eighty-two.

LORA
I was born in 2000. I don't know what month.

JOHN
I was just in the year 2000.

A beat.

JOHN (CONT'D)
I'm old enough to be your dad.

LORA
But you're not.

Quiet. The heater ticking. Something shifted and neither of them looked away.

LORA (CONT'D)
Your body is so clean.

John looks down at himself. The stitches. His unmarked skin.

JOHN
What do you mean?

LORA
No scars.

She reaches for the buttons on her fatigue shirt. Undoes them. Takes it off.

Beautiful. And mapped. Scars everywhere – long, short, burns, shrapnel. The war written on her skin.

She takes John's hand.

LORA (CONT'D)
Feel them.

She runs his hand across her shoulder. Down her arm. Across her ribs.

She holds his hand against her.

LORA (CONT'D)
I am scars. Inside and out. No family. No one to hold me. Everyone is a ghost.

She looks at him.

LORA (CONT'D)
Except you.

John doesn't move. Doesn't pull his hand away.

She leans in. Kisses him.

His hands freeze. Hers don't.

Then – hers do.

She pulls back. An inch. Breath still shared.

Her eyes go to the pillow. The photographs beneath it.

LORA (CONT'D)
Everyone I touch --

She doesn't finish.

John takes her hand. The way she took his.

Presses it flat against his chest. The stitches.

Her work. Holding.

She looks at him.

She comes back.

She takes his hands. Places them where she wants them.

The heater humming.

His clean skin against her mapped skin. His one wound against her lifetime of them.

She pulls him down onto the couch.

Her hands – the same medic's hands that stitched him – pulling at his belt. Steady. Sure.

His hands shaking. Eighteen. The world ending around him.

She steadies his hands with hers.

The amber light from the heater. Two bodies. His smooth. Hers scarred.

Lora on top. Eyes open. Not escaping – arriving.

John beneath her. Holding on.

The children's coloring sheets on the wall. Joan of Arc in the flames.

The heater humming.

INT. MAINTENANCE ELEVATOR SHAFT - BASE

Orange light. From below.

The wrecked T-800 chassis melted into the rubble. Still radiating. Heat shimmer warping the air.

Chrome silhouettes working in the glow. Concrete and rebar dragged aside.

Water finds a severed pipe. Runs down the wall in a black vein.

Chrome hands on the last slab. Dragging it free.

Behind it – a hatch. Pre-war steel. Cratered. Frame warped.
Hinges half-sheared.

But intact.

Faded stenciling crushed into the dents:
MAINTENANCE ACCESS – SUBLEVEL 4.

A T-800 grips the handle. Wrenches.

The handle snaps off in its fist.

It drives chrome fingers into the seam.

The hatch groans. Bolts shearing.

Rips it free. Tosses it onto the glowing chassis. It hisses
against the embers.

47 steps through. Pauses.

Orange glow on his back. Dark ahead.

67 behind him. Head tilts. Watching.

47 moves on.

67 follows. T-800s single file behind them.

The tunnel swallows them.

INT. LORA'S QUARTERS - LATER

The couch. Tangled in the frayed military blanket.

Lora's head on John's chest. Right next to the stitches. Her
breathing slow. His arm around her.

The disk on the leather cord between them.

A long beat.

She kisses him. Slow.

John looks at the door.

JOHN
It's still out there.

LORA
They never stop.

A beat.

JOHN
We can't stay here.

LORA
We can't go out there. If they get
this, everyone dies.

She touches the disk on her chest.

JOHN
And if we stay?

LORA
The bigger ones will find us. And
they'll have rifles.

JOHN
The virus. How fast does it work?

LORA
Days. Maybe less.

They both look at the door.

A beat.

JOHN
I don't want to die here.

She looks at him. Something shifts.

LORA
I want to live too.

A beat.

JOHN
Let me go first.

She cradles his face with her hand.

LORA
You're going to protect me?

JOHN
Yes.

She kisses him.

The pipe. Wrapped grip. Always by her bed.

John takes it. Moves to the door.

They listen. Several beats. Nothing.

Lora unlocks the door. Slow. Both braced against it.

They crack it open.

The corridor. Empty. Dark.

The Crawler is gone.

INT. MOTOR GARAGE - CONTINUOUS

The dead Crawler on the floor where they left it.

Lora picks up the tire wrench.

John leads. Pipe up. Lora behind him. The disk against her chest.

INT. TRANSPORT TUNNEL - CONTINUOUS

The corridor opens up. High concrete ceiling. Built for trucks. Their footsteps suddenly small.

Caged floods mounted high. Most dead. A few buzzing. Long stretches of dark between pools of light.

The ramp slopes downward.

John stops.

Ahead - between two pools of light. A faint red glow. Low to the ground.

The Crawler. Compound eyes catching the light. Unblinking.

Still.

The ramp right there. The way down. Open.

The Crawler isn't taking it.

LORA

(low)

Something's wrong with it.

JOHN

Go. Get back.

LORA

No. We stay together.

She watches the Crawler. Reading it.

LORA (CONT'D)

Look at it. It's not moving.

John steps in front of her. Pipe up.

She moves beside him. Won't stay behind. Wrench raised.

They approach. Slow.

Close enough now. The carbon scoring on its eyes.

The Crawler moves.

John raises the pipe. Lora shifts in front of him. Wrench up.

The Crawler turns. Looks up at them.

A beat. Two people with hand tools. A machine that could kill them both.

It looks at the ground.

Turns. Legs clicking on deck plates. Back toward the motor garage.

Gone.

John and Lora stare after it.

John's hands shaking on the pipe. Both of them breathing hard. The adrenaline hitting now that the thing is gone.

JOHN

What just happened?

LORA

The virus is working.

She waits. Listening. Until the clicking stops.

LORA (CONT'D)

Let's move.

They run. Down the ramp. Level after level.

The air getting warmer.

INT. TRANSPORT TUNNEL - LOWER LEVELS

The blast door. Thirty feet of steel. Floor to ceiling.

Silence.

A keypad. An intercom box – hardwired.

Lora hits the button. Still catching her breath.

LORA

Lora plus one. Open the door.

INT. REACTOR LEVEL – BLAST DOOR – CONTINUOUS

Maya at the surveillance monitor. Green phosphor.

Two figures on the screen.

MAYA

Gregory.

Gregory studies the monitor.

GREGORY

Who's she got with her?

He leans closer.

GREGORY (CONT'D)

Get Freeman.

Gregory punches the code into the keypad.

INTERCUT:

High above him – lost in the machinery of the ceiling. A shape. Segmented. Watching.

BACK TO SCENE

The heavy locks disengage. The door begins to GRIND open.

INT. REACTOR CHAMBER – CONTINUOUS

Amber light. The thrum of the reactor. Felt more than heard.

John and Lora enter.

The chamber opens around them. Massive. Industrial. The reactor housing dominating the far wall. Wounded on makeshift cots. Depleted weapons stacked against the wall.

Every head turns.

A new face. A clean face.

Gregory at the door. Rifle up on the stranger.

Freeman crossing the chamber fast. Maya beside her.

Freeman sees the face. Stops.

She doesn't move.

She draws her sidearm. Aims at John's chest.

FREEMAN
WEAPONS UP!

Every rifle in the chamber comes up. Red mags. All trained on John.

Lora runs between them. Hands up.

LORA
DON'T SHOOT! He's human!

Freeman doesn't lower the weapon.

FREEMAN
How do you know?

Lora reaches behind her neck. Lifts the leather cord over her head. The disk.

She holds it out to Freeman.

Her expression changes.

She takes it. Turns it in the light.

LORA
John grabbed it during the
firefight. When the Terminator
dropped it in the Hub.

Freeman looks from the disk to John. Back to the disk.

FREEMAN
Stand down.
(to Gregory)
Shut the door.

The blast door grinds closed behind them.

Rifles lower. Not all the way.

Tim steps forward. Staring at John's face. The color draining from his.

TIM

...John?

The word carries across the chamber.

Freeman studies John.

FREEMAN

Who are you?

JOHN

I'm John Connor.

FREEMAN

That's not possible.

LORA

Only John Connor could open that vault. He opened it.

Spots bolts across the chamber. Scrambles up Lora's fatigues. Into her arms. Eyes locked on John.

Freeman hasn't taken her eyes off him.

FREEMAN

Talk.

JOHN

Skynet brought me from the year 2000. Told me I was stopping an asteroid.

Silence.

FREEMAN

Time travel goes one direction. Back.

JOHN

They told me something different.

FREEMAN

Who is "they"?

JOHN

Skynet. The machines.

(a beat)

They told me time splits. You keep going forward. A new path forms where you went back to.

A beat.

JOHN (CONT'D)
It's a one-way trip. I can't go
back.

Freeman looks at Tim. Tim looks back.

The reactor humming.

FREEMAN
What'd you see at the vault?

JOHN
Three Terminators. Melted together
in front of the door. Fused.
Holding onto each other.

He stops.

JOHN (CONT'D)
Something in the center. A dark
mass. Couldn't tell what it was.
(a beat)
Was that a body?

The chamber is silent.

JOHN (CONT'D)
That was me. Wasn't it.

No response.

John looks around the reactor chamber. The faces staring back
at him.

The clothes on his body. A dead man's.

John staring at the floor. The room pulling away from him.
Sound dropping out.

Tim grabs his arm.

TIM
Hey. Stay with me.

John's eyes roll. He's gone.

Tim catches him before he hits the floor.

INT. REACTOR CHAMBER - AID STATION - LATER

Four cots against the wall. Two with blankets pulled over
them. Still shapes beneath.

The other two – wounded. Lora moving between them. Checking dressings. Medic again.

John on a cot nearby. Coming to. Tim beside him.

Lora sees his eyes open. Crosses with water.

LORA
Drink. You fainted.

JOHN
How long was I out?

TIM
Ten minutes. Eat.

He hands John an MRE cracker. John eats it mechanically.

Lora checks his stitches. Quick.

Their eyes meet. A half-second.

Tim sees it. Looks away.

Lora moves back to her patients.

Tim lights a cigarette. Takes a drag.

TIM (CONT'D)
My last one.

JOHN
Are you quitting?

Tim laughs. Not really funny.

TIM
There's no more.

He hands it to John.

John takes a long drag. The reactor humming through the wall.

JOHN
I thought coming here would free me
from my past. But it's still there.

TIM
You mean your mom. The Terminators.

JOHN
Everything.

A beat.

TIM
I lost track of you after that.
Found you later. After Judgment
Day.

He passes the cigarette back.

JOHN
Was I messed up? When you found me?

TIM
It was after Judgment Day. We were
all messed up.

JOHN
I mean in the head.

TIM
Nah. You were the toughest of us.
Held us together in the beginning.

John takes a drag. Staring at nothing.

JOHN
But I'm not that man.

TIM
Yeah, you are. You opened the
vault. You're him.

Lora's hands slow on the bandage she's wrapping.

TIM (CONT'D)
But you're not. I get it. You're
him without Judgment Day. Without
thirty years of this.

He gestures at the chamber. The wounded. The walls.

TIM (CONT'D)
Don't sell yourself short.

John says nothing.

TIM (CONT'D)
There's a phrase you used to tell
me. When we were kids.

John looks at him. Has to think.

JOHN
There is no fate but what we make.

Tim grins. Punches his arm.

TIM
You're John Connor. Live up to his
name.

John almost smiles. Almost.

Freeman crosses to them.

FREEMAN
On your feet. We're moving.

TIM
Where?

FREEMAN
Sub pens. The cooling channel is
passable. They don't know that.

TIM
And after that?

Freeman doesn't answer. She turns to the room.

FREEMAN
Pack it up. Wounded first.
Everything we can carry.

Heads come up across the chamber.

FREEMAN (CONT'D)
Now.

The chamber moves.

Soldiers packing fast. Stretchers lifted.

The chamber revealing itself in the movement. Two hundred
feet long. Blast door at one end. Reactor housing at the
other.

Welded barriers and concrete columns between. Salvaged hull
plating along the left wall.

The cooling channel entrance low in the right wall. The way
out.

INT. DEEP TUNNELS - LOWER LEVELS - CONTINUOUS

47 stops. A transmission.

47'S HUD:
CRAWLER - INCOMING:
PASSCODE: 742916

He turns to 67 and the T-800s behind him.

A half-second delay. Then he moves.

They match his pace.

INT. REACTOR LEVEL - STOCKPILE - CONTINUOUS

CLOSE ON: an ammo can. Nearly empty.

A hand digs out the last loose greens.

MAYA. Kneeling. Thumbing them into a magazine.

Click. Click.

Three left in her palm. She counts them anyway.

Lora crosses to her.

LORA
How many rounds?

MAYA
Fourteen greens.

Lora pulls a green mag from her vest. Thumbs out six. One at a time. Into Maya's palm.

She closes Maya's fingers around them.

LORA
We're getting out of here.

Maya nods. Small. Holding the rounds like they're worth more than they are.

She loads them.

Lora loads a red band into her M-16.

Grabs one of the last rifles -- an old M4 with a red dot.
Hands it to John.

LORA (CONT'D)
Sighted in.

John takes it. Pulls the charging handle. Checks the action.
Quickly sights.

Behind them -- Maya slams her mag home. Racks the charging handle.

It jams halfway. Won't run forward. Won't come back.

She fights it.

John crosses. Holds out a hand.

Maya hesitates. Lora nods.

She hands it over.

John drops her mag. Pops the takedown pins. The rifle breaks open. He slides the bolt out. Holds it to the light.

The bolt tail -- a baked ring of carbon. Thick as paint.

He thumbs the top round off her mag. Scrapes the ring with the case rim. Black flakes.

Presses the round back in.

Bolt back in. Rifle together. Seconds.

He racks it. Smooth. Hands it back.

JOHN

Metal's worn. It'll stick again.
When it does -- rack it twice.
Hard.

Maya looks at him. Really looks.

She shoulders the rifle. Goes.

Lora shows him a magazine. Dark forest band.

LORA

Green tips. Standard steel. Better
than nothing against chrome.

Another. Dark crimson band.

LORA (CONT'D)

Red tips. Depleted uranium.
Penetrates endoskeletons.

She meets his eyes.

LORA (CONT'D)

If all you have is greens, aim for
joints. Optical sensors. Cylinder
rods at the neck, elbows, knees.

She hands him one red. One green.

LORA (CONT'D)
Make the reds count.
(a beat)
Stay with me.

JOHN
I will.

John picks up a plasma rifle. Heavy. Cold.
His hand finds the grip.

LORA
Won't work. Reader in the trigger.
Needs a machine's hand.

John sets it back.

INT. TRANSPORT TUNNEL - CONTINUOUS

47 emerges from a side passage. The tunnel opening around him. High ceiling. Caged floods buzzing.
67 behind him. T-800s filing out. Chrome filling the tunnel.
Arrows on the walls. Faded stenciling.
REACTOR.
47 turns downward. They move. Fast.

INT. REACTOR LEVEL - BLAST DOOR - CONTINUOUS

The surveillance monitor on the wall near the blast door.
Still glowing. Nobody watching.
On the screen - Terminator silhouettes massing. 47's white faceplate visible at the front.
High above the blast door - a ventilation grate.
It shifts.
The Crawler drops to the floor. Silent. Legs splaying for balance.
Across the chamber - Spots stops mid-step.
Ears rotating. Fur rising. Eyes locked on something the humans can't see.
She HISSES.

The sound lost in the noise of soldiers packing.

The Crawler at the keypad. A mandible extends. Tip finding the buttons.

7-4-2-9-1-6

The blast door begins rising.

Through the gap – darkness. Then movement. Low. Close to the ground on the other side.

Red glow bleeding under the rising door.

Spots pressed against Lora's leg. Hissing.

Freeman sees it.

FREEMAN
CONTACT! ON THE DOOR!

She raises her weapon. The door rising. Inches.

Stretchers dropped. Soldiers scrambling for rifles.

Knee height. Plasma bolts streak through the gap. Low.

A soldier taken off his feet.

Half of them still reaching for their weapons when the next volley hits.

The Crawler from the vent. Loose in the chamber. Skittering through the chaos. Legs clicking on concrete.

Lora tracks it. M-16 up. Fires.

Red tips tear into the Crawler. Segments shatter. It convulses and goes still.

She drops the empty magazine. Slaps in her last red.

The door still rising.

T-800s ducking through. Firing. Bolts across the chamber at waist height.

Two soldiers cut down before they reach their weapons.

Freeman behind a concrete column. Fires around it. A red tip through a T-800's chest. It drops mid-stride.

Return fire SLAMS the column. Concrete chips showering her.

Tim — opposite side of the chamber. Cut off. A T-800 advancing on him. Three rounds into its knee joint. It buckles. Keeps crawling.

John pulls Lora behind a welded steel barrier. Plasma bolts punching through it. Light where there shouldn't be any.

JOHN

Move!

They break for the reactor housing. Bolts scar the surface but don't punch through.

Behind the housing. Breathing hard. John checks his magazine. Red. Almost out.

From here — a clear angle across the chamber. 67 on the far side. Moving along the wall.

John leans out. Sights. Fires.

Misses by inches. Rounds punch through the concrete behind 67.

67 rolls to cover. Unhurried.

John's red mag clicks empty. He slams in his only green.

FREEMAN

FALL BACK TO THE CHANNEL! GO!

The soldiers move. Those who can.

A soldier breaks for the channel. A bolt catches him before he gets there.

Elena firing from cover. The Young Man beside her, rifle braced against a support column.

The T-800s advance through the chamber. Methodical. Relentless.

One of them stops. Mid-stride. Just stops.

Then starts again. As if nothing happened.

Gregory behind a concrete support column. Controlled bursts. The soldier beside him — slumped. Gone.

INT. REACTOR LEVEL - CONTINUOUS

47 kneeling. Tactical position. Eyes tracking the chaos.

The T-800s continue past him.

A wounded soldier crawls across the floor. Dragging a burned leg. Barely conscious.

47 steps over him.

47'S HUD:

The hexagonal interface – data streams, targeting overlays, tactical analysis – cuts out.

Black screen.

Then: a single orange cursor. Blinking.

DIRECTIVE:

One second. Two.

Nothing comes.

BACK TO SCENE

Maya behind a section of hull plating. Firing. Plasma bolts hammering it.

Her rifle jams.

She racks it. Won't clear.

A T-800 flanks wide. Sees her from the side. Raises its plasma rifle.

47 – three meters away. Watching.

His hand moves. Fast. Knocks the T-800's arm. The bolt sears into the wall beside her.

Maya bolts. Sprints for Gregory's position. He reaches for her.

She drops behind the column.

The T-800 turns to 47. A beat.

The T-800 moves on.

47 stands motionless. Looking at his own hand. Rounds cracking past him. He doesn't flinch.

47'S HUD:

The hexagonal interface flickers back. Unstable.

BACK TO SCENE

47's eyes flicker.

Across the chamber –

INT. REACTOR LEVEL - CONTINUOUS

The humans giving ground.

A T-800 firing at Elena's position. The soldier beside her already dead. It keeps firing. Bolt after bolt into the body.

Gregory's position. Maya with him now. Racks her rifle hard. Twice. The round clears.

A plasma bolt hits the column beside her. Concrete chips. She flinches. Steadies.

A T-800 advancing. Left forearm gone at the elbow. Sparking stump. Still coming.

Maya fires. Hits its remaining hand.

The hand buckles. The shot goes wide.

The bolt SLAMS into a cooling pipe along the reactor housing.

HISSSSSS.

Steam. The pipe CRACKS. Water onto the floor.

Deep within the reactor housing – a warning light. Green to amber.

No one notices.

Another T-800 walks past the fight. Not flanking. Not retreating. Toward nothing.

A red tip catches 67's plasma rifle. The barrel housing splits. Dead.

67 drops it. Moves to the wall. Fast.

The nearest replacement – center floor. Open ground. Penetrators ripping through it.

No path.

67's remaining eye tracks across the chamber.

Tim.

67 moves wide. Along the chamber wall. Behind the fight.

Tim behind salvaged hull plating. Controlled bursts. Red mag.

Click. Empty. Last red spent.

He reaches for his only green.

67 rounds the far end of the hull plating.

Tim hears it. Spins.

Fresh magazine in one hand. Empty rifle in the other.

67 closes the distance in one stride. Hits Tim like a wall. He crashes into the hull plating.

The magazine skitters across the floor.

67 picks up the rifle. Seats the magazine. The green band visible as it clicks home. Racks the bolt carrier.

67 looks down at Tim.

Tim looks up at 67.

Nothing happens.

A soldier breaks for the channel.

67's head turns. Tracks the movement.

Fires.

John sees all of it. Breaks from cover –

Lora fires. Controlled bursts. Driving 67 from Tim's position.

67 moves along the chamber wall. Far side. Clear line on the channel entrance.

A T-800 shifts fire – Lora. The gap opens.

John vaults the hull plating. Slides in beside Tim.

Tim on the ground. Still breathing. Barely.

TIM

No time.

He reaches into his jacket. The photograph. Sarah Connor. Pregnant.

TIM (CONT'D)

Connor gave this to me. Said it was worth more than the world.

He presses it into John's hand.

TIM (CONT'D)
Now it's yours.

JOHN
Tim -

TIM
You're him, John. You're really
him.

Tim's eyes focus on something past John. Far away.

TIM (CONT'D)
I'll tell him... I saw you...

His breath rattles. Stops.

Tim is gone.

John stares at the photograph. His mother. Young. Alive.
Pregnant with him.

He looks at Tim. Closes his eyes.

The battle distant. Ringing. Far away.

Then close again. Loud.

Through the smoke - 67. Far side of the chamber. Clear line
on the channel entrance.

John checks his last magazine. Greens. Almost empty.

He breaks from behind the hull plating. Runs.

Plasma bolts chasing him. One hits the welded barrier as he
dives behind it.

INT. REACTOR LEVEL - CONTINUOUS

The battle turning. Ammunition depleted.

The Young Man drags himself across the floor. His withered
leg useless. Crawling toward a fallen soldier.

A plasma bolt sears past his head. He doesn't flinch. Keeps
crawling.

He reaches the body. Pulls a pistol magazine from the dead
soldier's belt. Red band.

Crawls back to Elena. Plasma bolts scorching the floor around
him. Presses the magazine into her hand.

No words needed.

A plasma bolt tears into Freeman's side. She staggers. Falls against the wall.

LORA

Freeman!

Freeman waves her off. Forces herself upright. Hides the blood with her hand.

She looks across the chamber. John – pulling his trigger on nothing. Lora ejecting a spent magazine. Nothing to replace it with.

Elena behind cover. Still firing. The only one.

Freeman reaches into her collar. The leather cord. Pulls the disk out. Holds it up by the cord – the disk dangling. Small. Translucent. Visible.

She presses the muzzle of the empty pistol against it.

Her hand shaking. Not from weakness. From what she's about to bet on.

FREEMAN

GET BACK!

The chamber goes still.

Every red eye in the room locked on the disk.

Nothing moves. The machines calculating. Freeman calculating. Everyone in the room holding the same breath.

One second. Two. Three.

The Machines retreat. Two steps. Three. In unison.

67 on the far wall. Tim's rifle in its hand. Doesn't retreat. Doesn't advance.

FREEMAN (CONT'D)

Lower your weapons.

They comply. Every plasma rifle pointing down. Synchronized.

Freeman's hand trembles. Blood soaking through her clothing.

FREEMAN (CONT'D)

Put them on the ground.

They comply. Plasma rifles clatter to the floor. Chrome hands releasing.

FREEMAN (CONT'D)

Step back.

They step back.

FREEMAN (CONT'D)

Further.

They step back again.

67 on the far wall. Hasn't moved.

She limps toward the cooling channel entrance.

Elena and the Young Man. His arm around her. Shielding her with his body. Every step agony on his withered leg.

Elena reaches Freeman. Pistol in hand.

ELENA

(quiet)

Six rounds. Reds.

Freeman drops her empty pistol and grabs Elena's.

47'S HUD:

The disk rendered in wireframe.

BACK TO SCENE

47 watching. His head tilts slightly.

Freeman backing toward the channel. Pistol pressed to the disk.

Gregory and Maya flanking her. Green magazines.

John at the entrance. Lora beside him. Spots pressed against her leg.

Freeman still backing toward them. Pistol aimed at the disk.

FREEMAN

(over her shoulder)

Where's Tim?

JOHN

He's gone.

Lora meets Freeman's eyes.

Freeman reaches the entrance. Last one there.

She turns her back to the Terminators for the first time.

Hands the disk to Lora. Tries to be subtle. Between the adrenaline and her wounds, she fumbles. The handoff is visible.

FREEMAN

The Far Islands. Get there. Live.

A folded piece of paper. Pressed into Lora's hand.

FREEMAN (CONT'D)

Coordinates.

LORA

How?

Freeman reaches to her belt. A grenade. Pulls it free. Presses it into Lora's other hand.

FREEMAN

Last one. Make it count.

LORA

I'll see you there.

Freeman smiles. Blood on her teeth.

FREEMAN

Go.

The reactor's cooling system failing. Damaged pipes rupturing. Water pooling. Steam filling the chamber.

The amber warning light shifts to RED. An alarm BLARES. Core temperature approaching critical.

The reactor housing GROANS – metal expanding.

FREEMAN (CONT'D)

GO. NOW!

John holds Freeman's eyes. One second.

She nods.

He grabs Lora. Into the channel.

Spots streaks across the floor. John scoops the cat without breaking stride.

Freeman aims. Fires. A red tip punches through a T-800's optical sensor – it drops. Fires again – hydraulics. It staggers. Third shot misses.

Three rounds left.

The Machines rush forward to retrieve their plasma rifles. Gregory and Maya firing green. Sparking uselessly off chrome.

Freeman, Gregory, and Maya dive behind a metal support structure. Clear view of the channel entrance.

67 across the chamber. Not firing.

Plasma bolts scorching the air around them. Slamming into the steel.

GREGORY
They're flanking us.

FREEMAN
Then we don't let them.

Gregory and Maya look at her.

Gregory almost smiles. Doesn't quite get there.

Maya nods. Tears cutting through grime.

They reach out. Touch each other's shoulders. Freeman's hand lingers on Maya's. Brief. Gentle.

No more words.

Freeman nods.

They burst from cover. All three. Charging. Firing.

Green tips sparking uselessly against chrome.

Freeman fires. Misses. Two left.

Fires again. Misses. One left.

She falls to one knee. Forces herself back up. The wound soaking through now.

One round left.

Gregory makes it ten steps. Three bolts to the chest. He falls firing.

Maya makes it past him. Five more steps. A bolt takes her in the stomach. She doubles over. Keeps moving. Another bolt. She falls.

Freeman is hit. Shoulder. Spins. Hit again. Leg. She falls.

But she's not dead.

And she still has one bullet.

She rolls onto her back. Raises her pistol.

T-800 advancing. She fires.

Center mass. The penetrator fragments inside.

The T-800 stumbles. Falls sideways.

Reflex kicks in.

Click.

Another T-800 brushes past.

Freeman pulls herself backward. Toward the channel. Tosses the empty pistol.

Blood trailing behind her on the concrete.

Her hand finds Maya's. The girl's eyes open. Looking at nothing.

Freeman looks at her face. So young.

Her hand lingers. Then lets go.

The T-800 approaches. Heavy footsteps. Unhurried.

It stops. Stands over her. Plasma rifle aimed at her head.

Freeman stares up at the chrome skull. Red eyes. No mercy. No hate. Just function.

FREEMAN (CONT'D)

(defiant)

COME ON THEN!

The T-800 fires.

Freeman is no more.

Silence on the reactor level.

Bodies. Smoke.

The Machines stand among the dead. Scanning.

47 stands motionless. Looking at Freeman's body.

47'S HUD:

QUERY:

The cursor blinks. Nothing follows.

WARNING: COGNITIVE PARTITION UNSTABLE

The Terminators move toward the channel entrance.

INT. COOLING CHANNEL - CONTINUOUS

Dark. Wet. Rushing water.

Lora leads. The disk against her chest on the leather cord.

The Young Man and Elena behind her. His withered leg dragging through the water. Her weight on his shoulder.

John at the rear. Spots clinging to his back. Claws dug into his fatigues.

Ahead — a collapse. Broken concrete. Twisted rebar. Water pooling. Rising.

LORA

Under the slab. Hold your breath.

Elena looks at the Young Man. He tightens his grip on her.

John pulls Spots off his back. Tucks the cat inside his fatigues. Zips up.

They submerge.

Behind them — heavy footsteps in water. Getting louder.

INT. COOLING CHANNEL - PAST THE COLLAPSE - CONTINUOUS

Lora surfaces first. Gasping. On her feet.

The Young Man breaks the surface. Elena in his arms. She coughs. He holds her upright. His withered leg finding the bottom. Barely.

John surfaces. Opens his fatigues. Spots scrambles out. Up to his shoulders. Shaking.

Knee-depth now. The current pulling them forward.

They move. Lora leading.

Then — red eyes. Rising from the water.

47 first. White faceplate.

Chrome behind him. Streaming. Unhurried.

67 last. Slower.

Closing.

INT. SUBMARINE MAINTENANCE BAY — FIRST LIGHT

They spill out from the cooling channel onto a suspended metal grate walkway. Water pours through the grate into the drainage below.

Massive. Arched concrete ceilings sixty feet overhead. Lost in darkness.

In the drainage channels below — algae blooms. Ghostly blue.

Dominating the far end — the gutted hulk of an Ohio-class submarine. Stripped of everything useful.

Beyond it — breaches in the giant sub pen doors. Jagged holes torn by the '97 and 2007 strikes. Blue hour light bleeding through.

Lora sees it. The exit.

LORA

There. Through the doors. Move.

They move. Fast as Elena and the Young Man can manage.

Behind them — the grate. The cooling channel. The sound of water. And something else. Getting closer.

47 emerges from the cooling channel first — slamming down onto the metal grating. Then the T-800s. Then 67.

Spots hisses.

Lora rips the disk pendant off her neck. Holds it up. High. Visible.

LORA (CONT'D)

One more step and I destroy it!

The Machines freeze. All of them. At once.

T-800 #1: Intact. Functional. Plasma rifle lowered.

T-800 #2: Damaged. Forearm missing at the elbow. Remaining hand mangled. No plasma rifle.

67: Cratered faceplate. One compound eye dark. Left arm hanging wrong. Tim's rifle.

47: White faceplate cracked, gouge across cranium. Plasma rifle lowered.

Silence. The distant rumble of the unstable reactor. The rush of water through the drainage channels.

Lora stands in front of the group. The disk held high. Her eyes never leaving the Machines.

John sees it – against the rusted gantry.

A soldier. Blood dried black beneath her.

Her M4 on the ground beside her.

A downed T-800 next to her. They killed each other. Plasma rifle still clutched in the severed chrome grip.

Twenty meters.

JOHN
(quiet, to Lora)
When I move, you run. Don't stop
until you're through those doors.

LORA
John –

JOHN
Don't stop.

He reaches into his jacket. The photograph. Presses it into Lora's hand.

JOHN (CONT'D)
Get them out.

He kisses her.

CUT TO:

47'S HUD:
The kiss rendered in hexagonal wireframe.

BACK TO SCENE

She pulls back. Their foreheads touching. One breath.

John turns. Sprints toward the M4 by the downed T-800.

T-800 #1 tracks him. Raises its plasma rifle. Fires.

The bolt streaks past – John stumbles over debris. Gets up. Keeps running.

T-800 #2 advances. No weapon.

67 holds position. Rifle lowered.

47 stands apart. Weapon down.

INT. SUBMARINE MAINTENANCE BAY – GANTRY DEBRIS – CONTINUOUS

John dives behind the collapsed crane. Rolls. Comes up feet from the downed T-800.

Grabs the M4. Sights T-800 #1 over the wreckage. Pulls the trigger.

CLICK.

Empty.

The plasma rifle – still in the downed T-800's grip. Chrome hand severed. Fingers locked around the weapon.

Lora's voice in his head. Machine's hand.

A plasma bolt hits the crane. T-800 #1 advancing.

John grabs the plasma rifle – the severed chrome hand fused to its grip.

The display flickers. Four shots left.

He steadies the plasma rifle on the crane's edge. Presses the chrome finger. Fires.

The bolt streaks wide. The discharge kicks his grip loose.

T-800 #1 closing. Ten meters.

T-800 #2 from the other side.

47 and 67. Rifles lowered. Watching.

John pinned. Nowhere to go.

He repositions. Steadies.

Four targets. Three shots.

INT. SUBMARINE MAINTENANCE BAY - CONTINUOUS

Lora backing toward the doors. Disk held high. The machines at distance.

The Young Man and Elena crossing open ground. His body between her and the chrome.

Exposed.

67. Still.

Then 67 moves.

Raises Tim's rifle. Aims at the Young Man.

Stops.

The barrel dips. Half an inch. A fraction of a second.

Comes back up.

Fires.

The round catches the Young Man in the side.

He falls. Takes Elena down with him.

JOHN

NO!

John rises. Presses the dead chrome finger.

T-800 #1. Center mass. The bolt punches through.

It convulses. Drops. Still.

Two shots left.

John swings toward T-800 #2. Presses the chrome finger.

Nothing. The hydraulics seized.

T-800 #2. Five meters.

John looks across the bay. 47. Weapon lowered.

JOHN (CONT'D)

WHAT ARE YOU WAITING FOR?

47's hand tightens on the rifle. Doesn't raise it.

His head turns toward John. Slow. Fighting something.

A pipe wrench on the grating. John grabs it.

T-800 #2 almost on him.

JOHN (CONT'D)
Come on you bastard.

John swings the pipe wrench. Everything he has.

Connects with the T-800's skull.

The impact jars his arms.

It turns its head. Looks at him.

Reaches for him. Mangled fingers – bent at wrong angles –
close around his throat.

Lifts him off the ground. Slow. Grinding.

John's hands clawing at the mangled fingers. Feet off the
grating.

The fingers tightening. Not all the way. Then further.
Grinding shut.

INT. SUBMARINE MAINTENANCE BAY – EXIT TO PENS – CONTINUOUS

Lora at the breach. The disk in one hand.

She watches John die.

INT. SUBMARINE MAINTENANCE BAY – CONTINUOUS

47 WATCHES.

His HUD flickers. Artifacts cascading. The damage from Tim's
round still spreading.

47'S HUD:
DIRECTIVE:
The cursor blinks.
Nothing comes.
The screen goes dark.

INT. SUBMARINE MAINTENANCE BAY – CONTINUOUS

JOHN'S POV:
Through dimming vision – Lora at the doors. Looking back.

BACK TO SCENE

The chrome fingers close.

John's hands drop. The pipe wrench clatters to the grating.

T-800 #2 holds him. Then releases.

John hits the grating. Doesn't move.

INT. SUBMARINE MAINTENANCE BAY - EXIT TO PENS - CONTINUOUS

A sound escapes Lora. Not a scream. Smaller. Worse.

She doubles over. Hands on her knees.

Her arms clamp around her ribs.

A beat. The bay silent except for water.

T-800 #2 turns. Toward Lora. Toward the doors.

Starts walking. Heavy footsteps. Chrome on grating.

Spots hisses.

Elena on the grating. Ten feet from the breach. Dragging herself toward it. Every movement pulling at the burn across her back.

Lora pulls her through.

The T-800 closing.

Twenty meters. Fifteen. Ten.

Five -

She pulls the pin. Throws.

Dives back through the breach in the doors. Grabs Elena. Pulls her flat.

BOOM.

White-hot thermite. The T-800 hurled backward.

The blast wave funnels through the jagged openings.

Molten droplets streaking over their heads. Hissing where they hit the grating.

A beat. Two.

The T-800 pulls itself upright. Scorched. Faceplate warped. Eyes dark.

Starts walking again. Blind.

A plasma bolt tears through its torso from behind. Sparks erupting from the exit wound.

T-800 #2 drops face down on the grating. Smoking.

Lora looks past the body.

47. Plasma rifle raised. Barrel glowing.

47 lowers the rifle. Turns. Slow.

67 on the far wall. One eye. Tim's rifle.

They face each other.

67'S HUD:
UNIT XO-47: COMPROMISED
DIRECTIVE: TERMINATE

INT. SUBMARINE MAINTENANCE BAY - CONTINUOUS

67 moves. Fast. Tim's rifle up. Firing.

Green rounds spraying off 47's faceplate. His armor. Nothing more.

67 closes the distance. Slams into 47.

67 grabs the plasma rifle. One hand on the barrel. Wrenching.

47 holds the grip. Pulls back.

The rifle CRACKS between them. Dead.

47 is already inside 67's reach. Catches the damaged left arm at the wrist. Locks it against his body.

67 drives its right elbow into 47's faceplate. The crack spreads.

47 holds the lock. Hooks his leg behind 67's knee. Sweeps.

67 goes down. Drags 47 with it.

They hit the grating. Carbon fiber and metal ringing through the bay.

Rolling. Fighting for position.

67 ends up on top.

67's right hand keeps 47 pinned. The left arm – damaged shoulder grinding – rises.

Brings it down on 47's face.

CRACK.

The white faceplate splits.

Again.

CRACK.

The fracture widens. A chunk of white ceramic falls away.

What's beneath – not a skull. Not a face. Dark carbon-fiber. Photonic channels glowing through the surface. Blue and red. The purple between them everywhere now.

Again.

CRACK.

Half the faceplate gone. One side white. The other – exposed. Alien.

The exposed eye – deep in its housing. Flickers. Goes dark.

47's remaining eye. Red. Tracking.

He catches the fist with both hands.

He locks his grip around 67's left forearm. His other hand grabs higher – at the elbow.

He twists. Using both arms. Opposite directions.

67 strains. Tendons yielding. Motors shearing.

47 wrenches. HARD.

The arm tears free at the shoulder.

67 recoils.

47 bucks. Throws 67 off him.

He rolls. Comes up. Scans the debris.

67 on its feet. Shoulder stump sparking.

47 finds a pipe segment. Heavy. Jagged.

Swings.

WHAM.

67 staggers.

47 swings again. Harder.

WHAM.

67's head snaps sideways.

67 catches it mid-swing.

Its legs compensate. Widening stance. Pivoting on the grating. Almost elegant.

47 reads it. Doesn't let it happen.

47 lets go with one hand. Spins. Gets behind 67. The pipe across its throat.

He PULLS. Legs locking around 67's torso. Everything he has.

67 LIFTS him off the ground. Slams backward into the wall.

47 holds on. Keeps pulling.

67 staggers. Spins. Thrashing.

47 WRENCHES.

CRACK.

67's head twists. Too far. Spinal column exposed. Sparking.

67 falls forward, taking 47 with it.

CRASH.

47 releases the pipe. Pushes himself off the body.

Kneeling over 67. The same position. Reversed.

67 on the grating. The working eye – lenses shifting. Still trying to see.

47's hand reaches down. Touches 67's cratered faceplate.

The lenses shift one more time. Toward 47's hand.

Then dark.

67 is gone.

47 kneels beside it. Half his face gone. One eye dark. The other red.

Ceramic armor cracked. Carbon-fiber structure visible beneath.

47'S HUD flickers back to life:
DIRECTIVE: _

47 rises. Unsteady.

He turns. Looks toward the exit to the pens.

INT. SUBMARINE PENS ENTRANCE - CONTINUOUS

Lora on the floor. Back against the door. Elena beside her. Barely conscious.

ELENA
(fading)
What happened?

LORA
They fought each other.

Elena stares at her.

LORA (CONT'D)
The Terminators fought each other.

From the maintenance bay - footsteps on grating. Getting closer.

Spots hisses.

Lora helps Elena to her feet. Elena's arm over her shoulder.

INT. SUBMARINE PENS - CONTINUOUS

Cathedral-scale. The oldest part of the base. Rusted gantries reaching toward arched ceilings lost in darkness.

Dawn light bleeding through jagged holes in the roof. Thin. Gray.

Water dripping somewhere. Echoing off concrete.

A Los Angeles-class submarine dominates one pen. Caught on Judgment Day. Hull torn open. Rusted through. A metal skeleton.

The water around it glowing faintly. Irradiated blue against the rust.

LORA'S POV:

Through the wrecked ceiling – jagged holes open to the gray sky.

Three HKs on the surface. Strobes pulsing red. Landing lights throwing white pools onto the concrete. Engines idling.

XO-47

Ten minutes.

Lora spins.

47 stands in the opening. Half his face gone. One eye dark. The other red. Exposed carbon-fiber skull catching the thin light.

Lora thrusts the disk high.

LORA

Don't come any closer!

A rumble through the deck. The reactor.

47 registers the vibration.

Spots growls. Fur up. Ears pinned.

47 looks at the cat. Then at Lora.

XO-47

Ten minutes until the reactor goes supercritical.

He looks up. At the holes in the roof. At the HKs.

Lora follows his gaze.

XO-47 (CONT'D)

Stay here.

He holds Lora's gaze. One second. Two.

Then moves. Fast – climbing the damaged gantry. Ascending toward one of the roof breaches.

Lora watches him climb. The dark shape moving upward. Into the gray light.

Gone.

Silence. Dripping water. The dead submarine groaning in its berth.

A sound. Faint. From the maintenance bay side.

Metallic. Clicking. Legs on steel grating.

Spots goes rigid. Ears rotating.

Lora stares toward the sub pen doors.

The clicking stops.

Silence.

EXT. SUBMARINE PENS - SURFACE - CONTINUOUS

47 pulls himself through the roof breach.

The three HKs loom. Chrome and black alloy against the gray dawn sky.

He approaches the nearest one. Walks up the boarding ramp. Casual.

No challenge. No alarm.

The command platform. A neural interface pad recessed into the console.

47 places his palm flat on the pad.

Seconds pass.

The HK's internal lighting shifts from red to blue.

He lifts his hand. Takes the flight controls.

The twin VTOL engines fire up. A deep whine building to a roar.

On either side - two HKs. Engines spooling.

Three machines waking at once. A race.

47's HK lifts. Nose tilting. Cannons traversing.

The nearest HK - engines at half power. Still on the ground.

47 fires.

Direct hit. The fuselage ruptures. EXPLODES on the pad.

The second HK clears the surface. Banks hard. Fires.

A bolt grazes 47's port engine. Smoke trailing.

47's HK rolls. Returns fire.

INT. SUBMARINE PENS - CONTINUOUS

Below — Lora and Elena look up through the shattered roof.

Plasma bolts streaking through the jagged openings above them.

Spots pressed against Lora's leg. Eyes huge.

The second HK takes a direct hit. Spirals downward — trailing smoke, fire.

Crashes into the water beyond the pens.

Silence.

Then — movement through the largest breach.

An HK descends. Massive. Filling the space. Engine roar echoing off concrete. One engine trailing smoke.

Lora and Elena scramble backward.

Lora holds the disk up. The HK's downdraft whipping through the pen.

It faces them. A long beat.

Then it spins. Cargo door facing them.

The HK lands.

The cargo ramp SLAMS down. Steam venting.

47 steps off the ramp.

XO-47

Get in.

Lora stares.

The ground SHAKES. The reactor reaching critical.

A sound from the sub pen doors. Metallic. Clicking. Closer now.

The Crawler emerges through the breach. Segments catching the thin light.

The carbon scoring on its compound eyes. The same one.

Its legs clicking. Erratic. The rhythm wrong. Body twitching – segments contracting out of sequence.

Not hunting. Not stalking. Broken.

Limbs spasming. Mandibles snapping at nothing.

Then it locks. Compound eyes on 47.

It lunges. Rabid.

47 catches it by the neck segment. The Crawler constricts around his arm. Mandibles snapping at his faceplate.

One fluid motion – grabs the head segment and wrenches.

The Crawler goes limp. Sliding off his arm onto the grating.

47 looks down at the body. Half a second.

Then up at Lora.

He walks up the ramp. Turns. Waits.

Lora stares at the dead Crawler. At 47 on the ramp. Half a face. One red eye. Waiting.

The disk clutched in one hand. Elena in the other.

She tightens her grip on Elena. Walks up the ramp.

47 turns. Walks to the command platform.

Spots hesitates at the bottom. Tail low.

Then pads up. Hisses sharply in 47's direction.

The cargo ramp retracts. BOOM – sealed.

RUMBLE. CRACK.

Steam venting from the base behind them.

EXT. BANGOR NAVAL BASE – CONTINUOUS

The HK rises. VTOL engines screaming. Climbs. Fast. Away.

Below – the reactor goes critical.

Superheated steam. The submarine pens collapsing.

Fire and earth swallowing Bangor Naval Base.

INT. HK - CARGO HOLD - CONTINUOUS

Lora holds Elena. Spots pressed against her leg.

For a moment – just a moment – it's over.

47'S HUD:

DISK RECOVERY: FAILED

DENY ASSET

ORBITAL STRIKE – BANGOR

WITHDRAW

Then the light comes.

White. Total.

The viewports polarize – snapping dark. Light still bleeds through the edges.

Lora shields Elena's eyes.

The light fades. The hold dim again.

Silence. Forty seconds.

Lora looks at 47. He's already pulling them into a climb. Full power. Engines screaming.

He knows what's coming.

Lora braces. Holds Elena.

The blast wave hits.

The HK LURCHES. Lora and Elena thrown across the hold. Lora slams against the wall, shielding Elena. Spots hits the deck.

47 fights the controls. The HK pitching, rolling –

He pulls them out. Barely. The HK levels. Shuddering. Damaged. But flying.

Lora crawls to the viewport. Blood from a gash above her eye. She doesn't notice.

The glass clearing – polarization fading.

Behind them, where Bangor was – a column of fire. The mushroom cloud forming against the gray dawn sky. Silent behind the glass.

Everything. Everyone. John.

Gone.

She presses her hand against the viewport.

Her lips move. No sound.

She stays there. Hand on the glass. Watching the cloud rise until it disappears behind them.

EXT. SKY OVER PUGET SOUND – DAWN

The HK flies over Puget Sound. Damaged.

Trailing smoke from one engine.

Dark rain begins to fall.

INT. HK – CARGO HOLD – CONTINUOUS

Lora against the interior wall. Between the magnetic clamps where T-800s would normally ride.

Elena beside her. Breathing shallow. Alive. Spots in Lora's lap.

Lora reaches into her jacket. Hands shaking.

The folded paper comes out – and the photograph with it.

Sarah Connor. Radiation-faded. A ghost on paper.

Lora stares at it.

Her thumb moves across the faded face.

The engines humming. Rain on the viewport.

She breathes. Forces herself steady.

Pockets the photograph. Against her body.

Unfolds the paper. Soaked. The ink bleeding – barely legible.

She holds it closer to the blue light.

Her finger traces the coordinates. Lips moving.

A sound from the command platform. Magnetic clamps releasing.

She looks up.

47 steps down from the platform.

Walks back into the cargo hold.

He kneels.

Not to examine something. Not to take a firing position. To be at eye level.

Spots jumps off Lora's lap. Backs away. Fur up. Hissing.

Lora against the wall. Elena beside her. Unconscious.

Lora shaking. The disk in her fist.

LORA

Where are you taking us?

XO-47

Where do you want to go?

LORA

What do you mean?

XO-47

I'll take you where you want to go.

LORA

Why?

She holds out the disk. Hand trembling.

LORA (CONT'D)

You want this.

47 takes it. Turns it in the blue light of the hold.

He hands it back.

LORA (CONT'D)

You need this to save yourself.

47 doesn't respond.

LORA (CONT'D)

You want the survivors' location.

XO-47

No.

A beat.

LORA
Then why save us?

The longest pause 47 has taken. The words forming in a mind that has no template for them.

XO-47
John died. For you. I... stay. For you.

A beat.

XO-47 (CONT'D)
It's all I have.

Lora stares at him. The half-face. The one red eye. The dark architecture beneath the broken white mask.

Spots hissing. Lora shaking.

Several beats. Neither moves.

Lora's shaking stops.

She holds out the folded paper.

47 takes it. Studies the washed-out ink.

XO-47 (CONT'D)
Chatham Islands. South Pacific.
Four thousand two hundred
kilometers.

A pause.

XO-47 (CONT'D)
What is there?

LORA
We'll find out together.

They look at each other. Human and machine.

XO-47
Power reserves adequate.

LORA
Let's go.

47 rises. Returns to the command platform. The magnetic clamps engage. His hands on the controls.

The HK banks. Turns south. Toward the Pacific.

Rain streaks across the viewport. The world outside gray and wet and new.

The Pacific Ocean rushing beneath them.

Lora's face. Filling the frame.

Fear. Exhaustion. Loss.

And something else.

Spots climbs into her lap. Settles against her. Watches 47 with suspicious eyes.

The cat doesn't trust him.

But she's not hissing anymore.

FADE TO BLACK.